

IN PROFILE

Jacopo Peri

Toward the end of the 16th century, Florentine humanists, obsessed with recovering the art and learning of the Ancient world, sought to recreate Ancient Greek drama, which was known to have included music. In 1598, in keeping with the spirit of this pursuit, the composer and singer Jacopo Peri (1561–1633) produced *La Dafne*, which is generally considered to be the first opera. He followed this up two years later with *Euridice*, the first opera whose score has survived to this day. The new fashion spread rapidly to other Italian cities, leading to Monteverdi writing *L'Orfeo* in Mantua in 1607.



JACOPO PERI, ALSO KNOWN AS II ZAZZERINO